Belmont, California

A strong El Niño raises the odds of a very wet winter on the Peninsula, and in Belmont a wet winter means power cuts, a flooding creek, and slopes that fail on the second storm. The deaths are most likely among 129 residents on powered medical equipment and 1,811 people over 75, including 297 in three elder-care homes. PG&E's battery programs do not cover storm outages, and the creek's flood basin is not built.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
The Climate Impact Lab region containing central San Mateo County (name not resolved)	None published for the US, California, or the county	Jun 2026 – Feb 2027 (heat only; not this hazard)	Storm power outages; Belmont Creek flooding; debris flows on saturated slopes; generator carbon monoxide

20/20 recommendations verified. 2 confirmed, 9 corrected (partially confirmed), 1 unverified, 8 contraindicated. The funding target moved from $165k to about $163k, down 1%, so the envelope stands. **The El Niño premise was tested, not assumed:** we classed 40 winters of daily rainfall at Redwood City, next to Belmont, by the official El Niño index. **Method caveat:** the session's web-search budget was exhausted before this run's research began, so every lens and verifier worked by fetching known sources directly. Belmont's own city pages refused automated reads, and no Belmont-specific storm damage record for 1982, 1998, 2017, or 2023 could be found. County-level records carry the history instead.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



37.52°N 122.29°W, United States of America · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** A very wet winter here means power cuts, a flooding creek, and failing slopes: the January 1982 storm killed 33 region-wide, 25 by landslide, and 129 residents now rely on powered medical equipment.
- **First action.** Care-home operators and San Mateo County Health hold RSV and high-dose flu clinics in Belmont's elder-care homes by mid-November, and reach everyone 75 and over by mid-December.*
- **The money.** About $43k floor, $163k target, $250k ceiling; the money goes to backup power for residents on powered equipment, someone to call them, and targeted carbon-monoxide alarms.
- **Do not.** Do not count on a portable battery to keep an oxygen concentrator running: a 2 kWh station lasts about 3 to 6 hours, and storm outages can last a day or more.*

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

DOES EL NIÑO MATTER HERE? THE PREMISE, TESTED

Redwood City daily rainfall (NOAA GHCN-Daily), October to March, winters 1973–74 to 2024–25, keeping the 40 winters with at least 90% of days reported. All five strong El Niño winters are included. Read every difference as a tilt, not a rule.

WINTERS	OCT–MAR RAIN (MM)	DAYS WITH 25 MM OR MORE	LARGEST 3-DAY TOTAL (MM)	WINTERS WITH A 3-DAY TOTAL OF 100 MM OR MORE
Strong El Niño (5)	620	6.2	89	2 of 5
Moderate or weak El Niño (10)	391	3.3	79	4 of 10
Neutral (13)	435	4.5	76	1 of 13
La Niña (12)	399	4.2	74	3 of 12
All winters (40)	436	4.3	78	10 of 40

- **Two very wet winters, three ordinary ones.** 1982–83 (962 mm) and 1997–98 (827 mm) were about double normal. 1991–92, 2015–16, and 2023–24 were near normal. The strongest El Niño on record, 2015–16, brought 482 mm.
- **More soaking days.** Strong winters had about 40% more days with 25 mm or more. Repeated soakings are what saturate slopes before the storm that brings them down.
- **What NOAA says now.** *"El Niño continues to strengthen, with a strong-to-very strong El Niño likely through January-March 2027"* (CPC, 8 October 2026). The seasonal outlook favors wetter-than-normal conditions near the California coast, at 50 to 60 percent (CPC, 17 September 2026).

EXPOSURE, HONESTLY WHO IS AT RISK, AND FROM WHAT

- **Older residents, many in care.** Of ZIP 94002's 27,534 residents, 3,833 are 65 or over and 1,811 are 75 or over; 783 people 65 or over live alone, and 46% of those 75 or over report a disability (ACS 2024, 5-year). Three licensed elder-care homes hold 297 beds: Ivy Park of

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Belmont (117), Silverado Belmont Hills memory care (112), and Vista Terrace of Belmont (68), plus five small adult residential homes with 32 beds.

- **People whose lives run on electricity.** 129 Medicare beneficiaries use electricity-dependent equipment, 23 use home oxygen, and 12 rely on dialysis (HHS emPOWER, queried 10 October 2026).
- **No PG&E backup in a storm.** PG&E's disability-access batteries are offered only during wildfire safety shutoffs, and its Portable Battery Program is closed for 2026. Most of Belmont lies outside a High Fire-Threat District; a pocket around Water Dog Lake is in Tier 2.
- **Flood losses fall on the uninsured.** ZIP 94002 has 29 flood-insurance claims since 1978, $174,333 paid in all, 62% of it in February 1980. Ten claims came in the 1982–83 El Niño winter. Since 2000 there have been three claims.
- **The county's slides kill in debris flows.** San Mateo County had the highest landslide cost of the ten Bay Area counties in 1997–98 ($55M of $158M) and the region's only landslide death, from a debris flow. Standard homeowners policies exclude earth movement.
- **Languages.** 739 Chinese speakers and 512 Spanish speakers speak English less than "very well."

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO

RANKED BY LIVES PER EFFORT

Actions 1 to 5 protect the people a winter or an outage is most likely to kill. Actions 6 to 9 cover flooding and the slopes. Actions 10 to 12 are slower fixes.

1. Hold RSV and high-dose flu clinics this month in Belmont's elder-care homes, and reach every resident 75 and over

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND FOR THE US

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Care-home operators with a pharmacy partner (to be named); San Mateo County Health; primary care	Clinics by mid-November; all 75 and over by mid-December	Covered by Medicare	Flu and RSV deaths, which outnumber storm deaths

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RSV vaccine was 75% effective against RSV hospitalization in adults 60 and over in its first season, and 76% in those 75 and over (Surie, JAMA 2024). It is a single dose, not annual. High-dose flu vaccine gave 24.2% more protection than the standard dose in adults 65 and over (DiazGranados, NEJM 2014). The three homes and five small residential homes hold 329 beds between them.*

Which pharmacy would run on-site clinics is unconfirmed. No San Mateo County flu-uptake figure for people 65 and over was found.

2. Stock a battery lending pool for storm outages through CID San Mateo, for residents on powered equipment other than oxygen, and claim PG&E's rebate for the Water Dog Lake pocket

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PHILANTHROPIST · SKEPTIC · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Center for Independence of Individuals with Disabilities (CID), San Mateo: the county's PG&E disability-access center	Units in place by 1 December	$86,940 (see funding)	Powered beds, CPAPs, and chairs failing in a long storm outage

PG&E's disability-access batteries are "only available during Public Safety Power Shutoffs," and its Portable Battery Program says it "has reached capacity for 2026." A winter storm outage triggers neither. CID San Mateo (2001 Winward Way, San Mateo; 650-645-1780) runs the county's disability-access program and had $2.0M in revenue in the year to September 2025.

A lending pool would be a new CID service; its capacity to run one is unconfirmed. Oxygen users are excluded: see Do not do this.

3. Enroll residents on powered equipment in Medical Baseline, and give them and the 783 people over 65 living alone a named person who calls during any outage, in Chinese and Spanish first

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Peninsula Volunteers (Meals on Wheels); Twin Pines Senior & Community Center; Belmont CERT	Lists by 15 November	$40k check-in coordinator and kits (see funding)	Someone isolated or powered-dependent going unchecked through a long outage

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Medical Baseline gives a lower rate and extra outage notifications. Peninsula Volunteers' Meals on Wheels serves homebound seniors and disabled people across San Mateo County. The 2003 New York City blackout raised accidental deaths by 122% and other deaths by 25% (Anderson and Bell 2012); that was a summer outage, so the transfer to winter is indirect.

Belmont is not named in Peninsula Volunteers' coverage, which is county-wide with waitlists that vary by area; confirm on 650-326-0665. Check-ins and kits would be new work for it.

4. Register older and hill residents for SMC Alert at their home address, with the landline voice option, at their door

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Belmont CERT, using the Belmont emergency-response district maps; San Mateo County DEM	Before the first atmospheric river	None	An evacuation warning that never reaches the people below a slope

SMC Alert is opt-in: residents who do not register "can't be reached for the majority of non-life threatening emergencies." Adding a home address lets alerts target a neighborhood, and voice messages can go to landlines. Wireless Emergency Alerts reach phones without registering.

Belmont's Genasys Protect evacuation zone numbers could not be read; the lookup is an app.

5. Install carbon-monoxide alarms for people over 65 living alone in homes with gas appliances and no working alarm, and spread a "generator outdoors only" warning in Chinese and Spanish

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
San Mateo Consolidated Fire's Sound the Alarm installs with the Red Cross; Belmont CERT	1 December	$11k for 200 sealed alarms (see funding)	Carbon-monoxide deaths from generators run indoors

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

In New Mexico, alarms "may have prevented approximately half" of 136 unintentional carbon-monoxide deaths (Yoon, JAMA 1998), a modelled estimate. A national study put the benefit of residential detectors "as high as 7.2 to 1" (Ran and others, 2018), an upper bound for the whole US, not a Belmont figure. San Mateo Consolidated Fire runs targeted free installs with the Red Cross but does not install alarms in individual private homes.

California already requires carbon-monoxide alarms in homes with fuel-burning appliances, so the gap is compliance and expired units; target, do not blanket-buy.

6. Households in the Belmont Creek flatlands buy flood insurance before about 9 November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: US FLOOD-MAP MISCLASSIFICATION (A CAUTION)

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Residents, renters included (contents cover)	About 9 November	Premiums vary	Uninsured flood losses in a wet winter

National Flood Insurance Program policies normally take effect 30 days after purchase, so cover bought after early November may not be in force for December storms. Ten of the ZIP's 29 claims came in the 1982–83 El Niño winter.

The 30-day rule is the standard one; the FEMA page confirming it could not be reached in this run.

7. Below steep slopes and at canyon mouths, leave during intense rain on already-wet ground, and watch the slope for new cracks, sticking doors, or tilting fences

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Residents, with San Mateo Consolidated Fire and county emergency management	Before the first atmospheric river	None	Being in a downslope room when a debris flow arrives

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

In the January 1982 storm, landslides caused 25 of the 33 deaths in the region, and debris flows killed 14. The county's one landslide death in 1997–98 was also a debris flow. San Mateo County received two federal disaster declarations in each of the 2006, 2017, and 2023 winters: slopes soaked by the first storm failed in the next.

No operational rainfall threshold for Belmont was found; the warning sign is the second big storm on wet ground, not a number.

8. Clear Belmont Creek inlets and storm drains, and the silt in the Harbor Industrial reach, before December

UNVERIFIED | EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Belmont Public Works; OneShoreline for the creek	1 December	Existing maintenance budgets	Blocked inlets turning moderate storms into street flooding

OneShoreline describes "severe erosion, bank failure, and incessant downstream flooding" in Twin Pines Park, with flooding and silt in the Harbor Industrial Area. Who maintains which reach, and on what schedule, could not be confirmed.

9. Put Belmont's hillside drainage and slope projects on a ready-to-submit list for federal mitigation money

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
City of Belmont, through Cal OES	Before the storms	Staff time	Losing a funding window that opens only after a disaster

The Hazard Mitigation Grant Program opens after a presidential disaster declaration, and the county has had 15 of them since 1982. Homeowners cannot apply directly; projects go through the state and need an adopted hazard mitigation plan.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

That a pre-built list speeds approval is an inference, not a FEMA statement.

10. Point households to energy-bill help (LIHEAP, CARE, FERA) through 2-1-1

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Volunteers; El Concilio of San Mateo County for PG&E bill help	October and November	Paid by federal LIHEAP and PG&E ratepayers	Rationed heat and power through the wet months

El Concilio lists help with PG&E bills and more than $350,000 in utility payments. The county's LIHEAP provider could not be confirmed, so send people to 2-1-1 or the state's service finder.

11. Train a CERT member for every Belmont emergency-response district

CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
San Mateo Consolidated Fire CERT	Fall 2026 academy	None to residents found	Streets with nobody trained when phones are down

San Mateo Consolidated Fire lists Belmont as a CERT area with its own district maps (dated 10 December 2025) and runs spring and fall academies, registered through its Eventbrite page.

12. Close the funding gap for the Belmont Creek detention basin, for 2027

CONFIRMED · AFTER THE PEAK | HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
OneShoreline, the City of Belmont, and the state	For 2027	About $9.6M gap ($17.6M estimate less $8M secured)	Repeat flooding below Twin Pines Park

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The plan is a 21.5 acre-foot underground basin under the Twin Pines Park parking lot and about 1,600 feet of creek restoration, cutting peak flow by 26 cubic feet per second, sized for a 10-year storm. About $8M has been secured from the state; no construction date is published. A local precedent: OneShoreline took over the Bayfront Canal and Atherton Channel project in January 2020 and finished construction in January 2022.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	Care-home operators & pharmacy	San Mateo County (Health, DEM)	CID San Mateo	Peninsula Volunteers	Twin Pines Center	SM Consolidated Fire & CERT	PG&E	City of Belmont & Public Works	OneShoreline	Residents
1. RSV and flu clinics	**A/R**	**R**			**C**					
2. Battery lending pool		**C**	**A/R**	**C**			**C**			
3. Medical Baseline and named callers			**R**	**A/R**	**R**	**R**	**I**			
4. SMC Alert at the door		**C**			**R**	**A/R**				**R**
5. CO alarms and generator warnings						**A/R**				**I**
6. Flood insurance before 9 November								**C**		**A/R**
7. Leave below slopes on the second storm		**R**				**A/R**				**R**
8. Creek inlets and silt								**A/R**	**R**	
9. Mitigation project list		**C**						**A/R**	**C**	
10. Energy-bill help via 2-1-1		**R**		**R**	**A/R**		**I**			
11. CERT in every district						**A/R**		**C**		**R**
12. Detention-basin funding								**R**	**A/R**	

What the chart shows. **San Mateo Consolidated Fire and its CERT volunteers are accountable for four rows**, every one of them about reaching people before a storm, so the fall academy is the bottleneck. **The money row, the battery pool, sits with a disability nonprofit** that runs PG&E's program but has never lent batteries for storm outages. **Residents are accountable for the two decisions only they can make**: buying flood cover in time, and leaving a downslope room on the second storm.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

Verified and corrected. The money goes to backup power for residents on powered equipment, someone to call them, targeted carbon-monoxide alarms, and a pre-agreed grant for a hotel room when an outage runs past a day.

FLOOR

About $43k

TARGET

About $163k

CEILING

About $250k

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

How many of the 129 already have backup power, and whether CID San Mateo can run a lending pool before December

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Arithmetic. Floor: half the battery pool, 30 × $1,199 + $7,500 = $43,470. Target: battery pool 60 × $1,199 + $15,000 delivery and charging = $86,940 + check-ins $40,000 + 200 alarms × $55 = $11,000 + outage hotel grant $25,000 = $162,940. Ceiling: batteries for all 106 non-oxygen device users, 106 × $1,199 + $15,000 = $142,094 (about 7% of CID's revenue) + $40,000 + 783 alarms × $55 = $43,065 + $25,000 = $250,159. The $40,000 check-in line and the $25,000 grant are estimates. The target fell 1% from the lens's $165k: batteries were repriced upward and the alarm line was cut to a targeted gap-fill.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
CID San Mateo	Action 2: battery lending pool for storm outages	$86,940	Restricted grant, stock in place by 1 December	60 × $1,199 (2,048 Wh station) + $15k; revenue $2.0M (FY2025)	Partially confirmed; a new service for CID
Peninsula Volunteers	Action 3: storm-day check-ins and shelf-stable kits	$40,000	Grant	$25k coordinator + 300 × $50 kits (estimates); revenue $7.7M	Partially confirmed; Belmont coverage to confirm
SM Consolidated Fire (Sound the Alarm) with CERT	Action 5: targeted CO alarms	$11,000	Bulk purchase, volunteer installs	200 × $55 (First Alert CO710 list price)	Partially confirmed; cut from $25k
CID San Mateo	Hotel nights and transport for device users when an outage passes 24 hours	$25,000	Pre-agreed restricted grant	Sized, not costed; released on PG&E's outage map, not a forecast	Partially confirmed; restructured from a foundation standby fund

The funder's one thing: every PG&E battery channel is tied to wildfire shutoffs or closed for 2026, and most of Belmont is outside the fire-threat map. A winter storm outage reaches none of them, so the cheapest life saved is a battery already sitting in CID's storeroom when the power goes.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Do not count on a portable battery to keep an oxygen concentrator running*

CONTRAINDICATED FOUND IN VERIFICATION

A 300–600 W concentrator runs about 3 to 6 hours on a 2 kWh station; storm outages can last a day or more.

Instead: Belmont's 23 home-oxygen users get backup cylinders from their oxygen supplier before December.

Do not send residents to PG&E's Portable Battery Program

CONTRAINDICATED SKEPTIC; CONFIRMED

It "has reached capacity for 2026," and it requires a past wildfire shutoff or repeated fast-trip outages, which storm outages are not.

Instead: Medical Baseline enrollment now, and the CID lending pool (actions 2 and 3).

Do not treat the Twin Pines detention basin as flood protection this winter

CONTRAINDICATED SKEPTIC; CONFIRMED

It has no construction date, its build alone takes three to four months, and it is sized only for a 10-year storm.

Instead: flood insurance by early November and cleared inlets (actions 6 and 8).

Do not tell residents to buy a generator*

CONTRAINDICATED CARRIED; APPLIES HERE

Indoor generators are a recurring cause of storm deaths; in January 2023 two men died at Sea Ranch with one running in a hallway.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: battery stations and a carbon-monoxide alarm (actions 2 and 5).

Do not tell people "you'll get an alert"

`CONTRAINDICATED` `CARRIED; CONFIRMED FOR BELMONT`

SMC Alert is opt-in, and without a registered address it cannot target a neighborhood.

Instead: register people at the door, with the landline option (action 4).

Do not hand out sandbags as the defense against hillside slides

`CONTRAINDICATED` `CARRIED; APPLIES HERE`

Debris flows killed people in 1982 and in this county in 1998; sandbags redirect shallow water and do not stop them.

Instead: keep sandbags for the creek flatlands, and leave downslope rooms on the second storm (action 7).

Do not buy parametric insurance triggered by 24-hour rainfall at a local gauge

`CONTRAINDICATED` `CARRIED; CONFIRMED`

No gauge or threshold matches where slides run, and the 1998 losses built up over a whole season, not a single day.

Instead: fund the battery pool and the basin.

Do not rely on the state's disaster utility protections before an emergency is declared

`CONTRAINDICATED` `CARRIED FROM THE ELMWOOD BRIEFING`

They apply after a qualifying declaration covering the county.

Instead: Medical Baseline and bill help now (actions 3 and 10).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1980 (February)	Flooding in ZIP 94002	3 insured claims, $108,138: 62% of all flood payouts here since 1978	Not found
1981–82 (December–January)	Bay Area storm (federal declaration DR-651)	33 deaths region-wide, 25 from landslides; 14 killed by debris flows	USGS study of the storm
1982–83	Strong El Niño (DR-677)	10 flood claims in ZIP 94002	Not found
1986, 1995, 1996–97	Winter storms (DR-758, DR-1044, DR-1046, DR-1155)	Not broken down for Belmont	Not found
1997–98	Strong El Niño (DR-1203)	County landslide cost $55M, highest in the Bay Area; the region's only landslide death	Not found
2005–06, 2016–17, 2022–23	Two federal declarations in each winter	Not broken down for Belmont	The pattern below
2015–16	The strongest El Niño on record	No declaration	—
2020	Belmont Creek watershed plan	"Severe erosion, bank failure, and incessant downstream flooding" at Twin Pines Park	Detention basin planned; about $8M of $17.6M secured; no construction date

The recurrence nobody has noticed: the deadliest storm on record, January 1982, came the season before that El Niño began, and the strongest El Niño, 2015–16, brought no declaration. What recurs is the second big storm on wet ground: three of the last four disaster winters brought two declarations. Plan for the second storm, whatever the index says.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — RESOLVED AND OPEN

- **Resolved: who gets the batteries first?** The Philanthropist put the 23 oxygen users first. Verification found a station runs a concentrator for only 3 to 6 hours, so oxygen users go to their supplier for cylinders, and batteries go to other powered equipment.*
- **Resolved: is Belmont in the fire-threat map?** Most of it is not, which closes PG&E's battery channels; a pocket around Water Dog Lake is in Tier 2 and may qualify for the rebate.
- **Open: is El Niño even the right frame?** The Historian found the county's deadliest winters were not strong El Niño winters; the premise test found strong winters do double the odds of a very wet season. Both point to the same action: be ready for repeated storms on saturated ground.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

Belmont's own storm record. No lens could find where Belmont's slopes failed or its streets flooded in 1982, 1998, 2017, or 2023; the city's pages refused automated reads and the session could not search. The actions rest on county records. A call to Belmont Public Works and San Mateo Consolidated Fire for their storm logs would sharpen actions 7 and 8 more than anything else.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Seven simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people. They are not neighborhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED — METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The request gave a street address; it was widened to the City of Belmont (ZIP 94002), the smallest unit with data. Which neighborhood the address sits in could not be confirmed. Climate Impact Lab impact region: the one containing central San Mateo County,

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

name not resolved. Mortality figures exist only at about 300,000 people; city detail is used for hazards and actions, not death counts.

- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Where heat is not the dominant hazard, the historical record carries the hazard instead of a borrowed number.
- **Expert panel.** Seven simulated expert lenses (an emergency manager, a public health scientist, a frontline responder, a skeptic, an economist, a historian, and a philanthropist) each researched this place independently and in parallel, to a fixed brief. They were given the verified findings of the neighboring El Cerrito, Elmwood (Berkeley), and San Francisco briefings. The El Niño premise test was run on NOAA station data (Redwood City USC00047339; SFO as a cross-check) for this briefing and El Cerrito's together.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Three verifier agents checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability in this jurisdiction, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Consulted earlier the same day by reading the dataset embedded in the inventory page: 96 entries. The relevant US entries are winter weather advisories and flood-map misclassification; nothing covers backup power, carbon-monoxide alarms, or debris-flow warnings.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (vaccines and doses, oxygen and medical equipment in an outage, and generators and carbon monoxide) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. **The session's web-search budget was exhausted before this run, so all research and verification used direct fetches of known sources.** belmont.gov returned 403 to every request. Unconfirmed: Belmont-specific storm damage, the county's LIHEAP provider, Peninsula Volunteers' Belmont coverage, CID's capacity to run a lending pool, Belmont's evacuation zone numbers, and the FEMA waiting-period page.

References · Premise: CPC Oceanic Niño Index · GHCN-D Redwood City (fetched) · CPC ENSO discussion, 8 Oct 2026 (verified) · CPC long-lead discussion (verified)
People and health: ACS 2024 5-year, ZCTA 94002 (verified) · HHS emPOWER (queried) · CDSS licensed facilities (verified) · Surie 2024, RSV (verified) · DiazGranados 2014 (verified) · Yoon 1998 (verified) · Ran 2018, CO detector benefit (verified) · Anderson and Bell 2012 (verified)
Power and alerts: PG&E DDAR fact sheet (verified) · Portable Battery Program (verified) · CPUC High Fire-Threat District layer (queried) · CID San Mateo (verified) · CID San Mateo 990 (verified) · Peninsula Volunteers Meals on Wheels (verified) · Peninsula Volunteers 990 (verified) · SMC Alert (verified) · SM Consolidated Fire CERT areas (verified) · SM Consolidated Fire, alarms (verified) · First Alert price list · EcoFlow price list
Flood, slides, and money: OpenFEMA NFIP claims, 94002 (queried) · FEMA declarations, San Mateo County (queried) · USGS PP 1434 (verified) · USGS MF-2325, 1997–98 landslides (verified) · OneShoreline, Belmont Creek (verified) · Twin Pines detention basin, Alt 2E (verified) · Bayfront Canal precedent (verified) · El Concilio of San Mateo County · CSD service finder
Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory
Generated 10 October 2026 for Belmont, California. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.